

MacSync

MES Large Events Management Platform

Staff & Admin Guide

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Chapter 1

Introduction

1.1 About MacSync

MacSync is an event management platform built for the McMaster Engineering Society (MES). It enables MES clubs and staff to create, manage, and promote large-scale events. Staff manage everything through the web-based admin portal at admin.macsync.org, while members use the mobile app to discover and attend events. Both interfaces share the same account system.

1.2 Who This Guide Is For

This guide is for **staff and administrators** — anyone with a staff role who uses the admin portal to create or manage events, as well as System Admins who manage users, roles, and platform settings. For the member-facing mobile app, refer to the *MacSync Member Guide*.

1.3 How to Use This Guide

Start with Chapter 2 to access the admin portal, then refer to the relevant chapters for each feature. Callout boxes highlight important information:

Note

Notes provide extra context or background information.

Warning

Warnings flag actions that could have unintended consequences.

Tip

Tips share best practices and useful shortcuts.

1.4 System Requirements

- Modern web browser: Chrome, Firefox, Safari, or Edge.
- Active internet connection.
- A valid @mcmaster.ca account with a staff role or System Admin privileges.

Chapter 2

Getting Started

2.1 The Two MacSync Portals

MacSync has two interfaces that share the same account system:

Table 2.1: MacSync Portals Overview

Portal	Who It's For	What You Can Do
Mobile App	All users (Members and Staff)	Browse events, register, purchase tickets, manage seat selections, view notifications. Staff can also create and manage events.
Web Admin Portal	Staff and System Admins only	Create and manage events, manage users and roles, view attendee details, download venue reports, send notifications.

Note

Staff can use **both** portals. Use the mobile app as an attendee and the web admin portal to manage events.

2.2 Accessing the Admin Portal

Navigate to `admin.macsync.org` in any modern web browser.

Note

Only `@mcmaster.ca` accounts with an Admin role, a custom staff role, or System Admin privileges can access this portal. Regular Members will see an “*Access denied. Sign in with a system administrator or event staff account*” message.

2.3 Logging In

1. Go to `admin.macsync.org`.
2. Enter your `@mcmaster.ca` email and password.
3. Click **Sign in**.

2.4 Navigating the Admin Portal

Once logged in, the sidebar provides access to:

- **Dashboard** — Overview of platform activity.
- **Events** — Create, edit, delete, and view events you manage.
- **Manage Roles** — Create and delete custom roles (System Admins only).
- **Users** — View and manage all registered users (System Admins only).
- **Notifications** — Send announcements to event attendees.

Chapter 3

User Roles & Permissions

3.1 Role Overview

MacSync uses a flexible role-based access control (RBAC) system. Every registered user automatically receives the **Member** role. Additional roles can be created by a System Admin and assigned to users to grant event management privileges. A user can hold **multiple roles simultaneously**.

There are two built-in roles on every MacSync instance:

Table 3.1: Built-in Roles

Role	Protected	Description
Member	Yes	Default role for every registered user. Can browse and register for events. Cannot create or manage events.
Admin	No	Staff role. Can create events and manage events where their role matches the event's Managing Role.

Custom roles (e.g. `MES_ADMIN`) can be created from the **Manage Roles** page and assigned to any combination of users.

3.2 System Admin

The **System Admin** privilege is a special toggle separate from roles, found under **Advanced Settings** on any user's profile.

- A System Admin has **unrestricted access** to all platform features, events, users, and settings with no role restrictions.
- Only an existing System Admin can grant or revoke this privilege.
- In production, this should be held by MES Presidents and senior executives.

Warning

System Admin is listed under **Advanced Settings — Dangerous actions and system-level changes**. Grant this privilege carefully — it overrides all role and event-level restrictions.

3.3 How the Managing Role Works

Every event has a **Managing Role** field that determines which staff users can edit, delete, and view attendee data for that event.

- When creating an event, the managing role defaults to the creator's highest assigned role.
- Any user who holds the matching role can administer that event.
- Example: if an event's managing role is `MES_ADMIN`, all users with the `MES_ADMIN` role can manage it.
- System Admins can manage all events regardless of managing role.

Tip

To restrict an event to a specific team, create a custom role (e.g. `HATCH_EXEC`), assign it only to that team's members, and set it as the managing role when creating the event.

3.4 Creating a New Role (System Admin Only)

1. Navigate to **Manage Roles** in the sidebar.
2. Under **Create a new role**, enter a role name.

3. Click **Create role**.

Note

Role names are case-sensitive. Use consistent naming conventions (e.g. all caps with underscores: `CLUB_EXEC`).

3.5 Deleting a Role (System Admin Only)

1. Navigate to **Manage Roles**.
2. Find the role under **Existing roles**.
3. Click **Delete role**.

Warning

Deleting a role removes it from all users currently assigned that role and from any events using it as their managing role. The **Member** role is protected and cannot be deleted.

3.6 Assigning Roles to a User (System Admin Only)

1. Navigate to **Users** and click the target user.
2. Click **Show advanced settings**.
3. Under **Roles**, check the boxes for all roles to assign.
4. Click **Save roles**.

The user's active roles are displayed in the top-right of their profile page.

3.7 Granting System Admin Privileges (System Admin Only)

1. Navigate to **Users** and open the target user's profile.
2. Click **Show advanced settings**.
3. Toggle **System admin** to the on position.

Warning

There is no confirmation dialog for this action. Verify you have the correct user's profile open before enabling System Admin.

Chapter 4

Managing Events

4.1 Creating an Event

Any user with an Admin role or a custom staff role can create events. Regular Members cannot create events.

1. From the sidebar, click **Events**, then click **Create event** in the top-right corner.
2. Fill in the event details (see Section 4.2).
3. Configure optional signup settings if needed (see Sections 4.3 and 4.4).
4. Set the **Managing role** to control which staff can administer this event.
5. Click **Create event** to publish.

4.2 Event Form Fields

Table 4.1: Create Event — Field Reference

Field	Required	Description
Name	Yes	The public-facing title of the event.
Description	No	A summary of the event.
Date & Time	Yes	Date and start time in <code>yyyy-mm-dd hh:mm</code> format.
Capacity	No	Maximum number of attendees. Leave blank for unlimited.
Location	Yes	The venue or address where the event is held.
Price (USD)	No	Ticket price. Leave empty or enter 0 for a free event with no payment screen.
Image URL	No	A direct URL to an externally hosted image used as the event banner.
Requires table signup	No	Enables table and seat selection for attendees. See Section 4.3.
Requires bus signup	No	Enables bus and seat selection for attendees. See Section 4.4.

4.3 Table Signup Configuration

When **Requires table signup** is checked, you will be prompted to enter:

- Number of tables at the venue.
- Seats per table.

Attendees will then choose their preferred table number and seat number when registering. Selection is by number only — there is no visual seating map.

Note

Table and seat assignments are visible in the Registered Attendees panel on the event detail page.

4.4 Bus Signup Configuration

When **Requires bus signup** is checked, you will be prompted to enter:

- Number of buses available.
- Seats per bus.

Attendees will choose their preferred bus number and seat number when registering.

4.5 Viewing an Event

Clicking an event from the **Events** list opens the event detail page. What you see depends on whether your role matches the event's managing role:

All staff can see:

- Event metadata: description, location, capacity, price.
- Seating configuration (tables and/or buses, if configured).

Staff with the matching managing role (and System Admins) additionally see:

- **Edit event**, **Delete**, and **Download venue report** buttons.
- **Managing role** selector.
- **Registered Attendees** table with contact details, seat assignments, check-in status, and sign-up timestamps.

4.6 Registered Attendees Table

The Registered Attendees section shows a full table of everyone signed up, with the following columns:

Table 4.2: Registered Attendees Table Columns

Column	Description
Attendee	Full name and McMaster program.
Contact	Email address and phone number.
Table Seat	Assigned table and seat (if table signup enabled).
Bus Seat	Assigned bus and seat (if bus signup enabled).
Check-in	Not checked in or Checked in .
Signed Up	Date and time of registration.

4.7 Editing an Event

1. Open the event detail page.
2. Click **Edit event**.
3. Update the relevant fields.
4. Click **Save** to apply changes.

4.8 Deleting an Event

Warning

Deleting an event is **permanent and cannot be undone**. All associated registrations and attendee data will also be removed.

1. Open the event detail page.
2. Click **Delete**.
3. Confirm the deletion in the dialog that appears.

Chapter 5

Venue Reports

5.1 Downloading a Venue Report

The venue report is a PDF summary of an event's details and registered attendees, suitable for sharing with venue coordinators or transport providers.

1. Navigate to **Events** and click the relevant event.
2. Click **Download venue report** at the top of the page.
3. The PDF will download automatically.

Note

The **Download venue report** button is only visible to staff whose role matches the event's managing role, and to System Admins.

5.2 What the Venue Report Contains

The report is a two-page PDF structured as a formal invoice:

Page 1 — Event Summary:

- Invoice number, issue date, and status.
- Event name, description, location, date/time, price per ticket, capacity, and prepared-by name.
- Seating configuration — tables and seats per table.
- Transportation — number of buses, seats per bus.

Page 2 — Registered Attendees:

- Total registered count.
- Table listing each attendee's name, program, email, table assignment, bus assignment, and sign-up date.

Tip

The venue report is ideal for sharing with venue coordinators, catering teams, or transportation providers ahead of the event.

Chapter 6

Notifications

6.1 Overview

Staff can send push notifications to all registered attendees of an event from the **Notifications** page. You can only send notifications for events whose managing role matches one of your assigned roles. System Admins can send notifications for any event.

6.2 Sending a Notification

1. Navigate to **Notifications** in the sidebar.
2. Use the **Event** dropdown to select the event. Only events you have permission to manage will appear.
3. The form shows how many attendees will be notified.
4. Optionally enter a **Message** for extra context.
5. Click **Send Notification**.

A confirmation banner will appear: “*Notification sent to N attendee(s).*” The button is then disabled for **60 minutes**.

Warning

There is a **60-minute cooldown** between notifications for the same event. A warning banner will appear if a cooldown is active. Plan your notifications carefully, especially close to event time.

Tip

Only attendees **registered** for the selected event will receive the notification.

Chapter 7

Managing Users

7.1 Overview

The **Users** page lists every registered MacSync user. Access level determines what you can do on a user's profile:

Table 7.1: Users Page — Access by Privilege Level

Privilege	What They Can See / Do
Staff (any role)	View public profile: name, email, tickets purchased, events attended, program, and ticket history.
System Admin	Everything above, plus Advanced Settings: assign/remove roles, toggle System Admin, delete the user.

7.2 Viewing the Users List

1. Navigate to **Users** in the sidebar.
2. The list shows all registered users with their name, email, and any special privilege badges (e.g. `SYSTEM_ADMIN`).
3. Use the **Search users by name or email** field to find a specific user.

7.3 Viewing a User Profile

Click any user to open their profile, which displays:

- Name, email, and active roles (shown top-right).
- Tickets purchased, events attended, and McMaster program.
- Full ticket history: event name, date, location, price, purchase date, seat assignment, and check-in status.

7.4 Deleting a User (System Admin Only)

Warning

Deleting a user is **permanent and cannot be undone**. All associated data including tickets, registrations, and seat assignments will be removed.

1. Open the user's profile.
2. Click **Show advanced settings**.
3. Click **Delete user** and confirm.

Chapter 8

Glossary

Admin	A built-in staff role. Can create and manage events where their role matches the event's managing role.
Check-in	The process of scanning a user's QR code at the event entrance to mark them as attended.
Entry QR Code	A unique scannable code on a user's ticket used for event check-in.
Event	A scheduled activity created and managed within MacSync, visible to all registered users on the mobile app.
Managing Role	The role assigned to an event that determines which staff users can edit, delete, and manage it.
Member	The default role for every registered MacSync user. Can browse and register for events.
MES	McMaster Engineering Society — the organisation that operates the MacSync platform.
RBAC	Role-Based Access Control — the permission system governing what each user can do based on their roles.
System Admin	A special privilege toggle granting unrestricted access to all platform features, events, and settings.
Venue Report	A two-page PDF summarising an event's details, seating, transportation, and registered attendees.